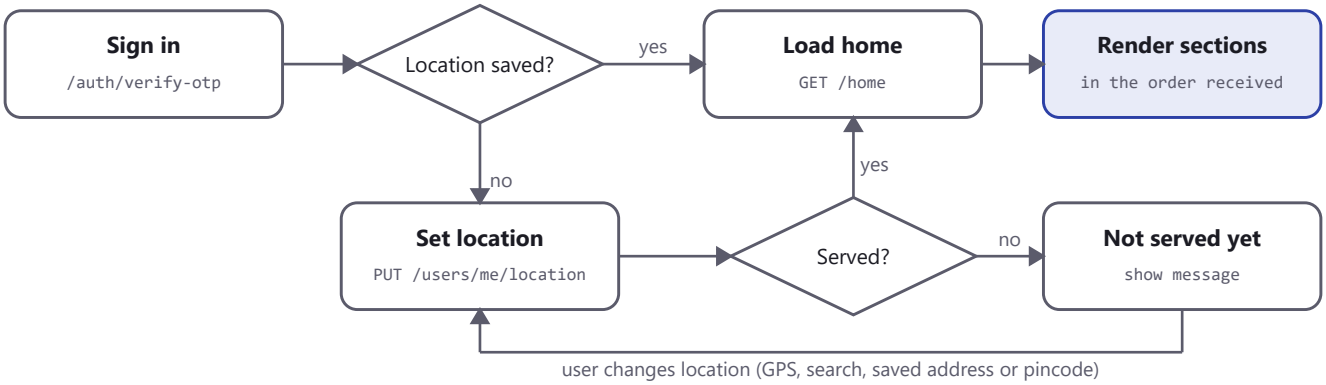
Meal Ji app integration: sign-in to home

How the React Native app replaces its hard-coded start and home screens with the Meal Ji API. Every example below is a real response from the API with demo data.

For the MealJi app developer · API v1 · 9 Oct 2026



A returning user with a saved location goes straight to home. A location outside every delivery zone loops back until the user picks one we serve.

Call order

1. App start: `GET /app/config` (version gate, maintenance, feature switches) and `GET /onboarding/slides` before sign-in.
2. Sign in: `POST /auth/login` then `POST /auth/verify-otp`. Check `data.user.currentLocation`.
3. No saved location: get one (GPS, place search, saved address or pincode) and save it with `PUT /users/me/location`.
4. If `serviceability.serviceable` is false, show its message and let the user change the location.
5. Load home: `GET /home?latitude=..&longitude=..` and render `sections` in order, plus header, cart bar and bell from the same response.

1. API basics

Item	Value
Base URL	`<API host>/api/v1`. Local: `http://localhost:4000/api/v1` (Android emulator `http://10.0.2.2:4000/api/v1`). Production host to be announced.
App config change	`CONFIG.BASE_URL` in `src/constants/config.ts` is `https://api.mealji.com/v1`; the path must be `/api/v1`.
Headers	`Authorization: Bearer <accessToken>` on every signed-in call; `x-device-id: <stable install id>` (8+ characters, same value on every call, including login); `Content-Type: application/json`.
Money	Integers in paise: `pricePaise: 34900` = ₹349. Divide by 100 to display.
Dates	ISO 8601 UTC. Show in IST (Asia/Kolkata). Calendar dates are YYYY-MM-DD.
Images	Full HTTPS CDN URLs. Load as remote images; nothing is bundled.
IDs	`<thing>Id`: dishId, comboId, planId, addressId, bannerId, themeId.

Response envelope

```
{ "success": true, "message": "Home fetched.", "data": { … } }
```

Errors use the same envelope with `"success": false` and optional `errors: [{ field, message }]`. Show `message` to the user; it is written for customers.

Tokens

- Access token lasts 1 hour (`expiresIn: 3600`); refresh token 60 days.
- On a 401: call `POST /auth/refresh` with `{ "refreshToken": "…" }` and the same x-device-id, store both new tokens, retry once. If refresh fails, go to login.
- Two refreshes at the same moment are safe: both get the same new token.

Field names

Use one name per idea. Older aliases still arrive but will be removed.

Use	Not	On
`name`	`title`	combos
`originalPricePaise`	`mrpPaise`	plans
`ratingAvg` + `ratingCount`	`rating`	dishes
`servesCount`	`serves`	combos

2. App start and sign-in

App config

`GET /app/config` (no sign-in). Gate the app on `minSupportedVersion` / `forceUpdate`; show `maintenanceMessage` when `maintenanceMode` is true. `mealSlotsShown` is the slots to show (lunch only today).

```
{
  "minSupportedVersion": "1.0.0",
  "latestVersion": "1.0.0",
  "forceUpdate": false,
  "maintenanceMode": false,
  "maintenanceMessage": "",
  "mealSlotsShown": [
    "lunch"
  ],
  "featurePickup": false,
  "featureScheduledDelivery": false,
  "featureReferrals": false,
  "featureWallet": false,
  "supportPhone": "",
  …
```

Onboarding

`GET /onboarding/slides` (no sign-in): the three onboarding steps with title, subtitle and image, in order.


```
[
  {
    "slideId": "6ac76e…",
    "title": "Hey. I'm the chef at Meal Ji.",
    "subtitle": "One kitchen. One menu. Cooked and packed by the same people every t…",
    "imageUrl": "https://…/seed/mascot-1024.png",
    "sortOrder": 0,
    "isActive": true
  }
]
```


Sign-in

Step	Call	Notes
Send code	`POST /auth/login` `{ "countryCode": "+91", "phoneNumber": "9000000031" }`	Returns `userId`, `otpLength` (6) and `resendAfterSec` (45) for the OTP boxes and resend timer.
Resend	`POST /auth/resend-otp` { `"userId"` }	Wait `resendAfterSec` first; 429 if too soon.
Verify	`POST /auth/verify-otp` `{ "userId", "otp" }`	Returns tokens, `isNewUser`, `profileComplete` and `user` (with `currentLocation`). Wrong code: 400 "Invalid OTP."
Profile	`GET /users/me`, `PATCH /users/me` { name, email, dob, gender }	Ask for a name when `profileComplete` is false.

Verify response (trimmed)


```
{
  "success": true,
  "message": "Phone number verified successfully.",
  "data": {
    "userId": "6ac4ba…",
    "accessToken": "<jwt>",
    "refreshToken": "<token>",
    "expiresIn": 3600,
    "isNewUser": false,
    "profileComplete": true,
    "message": "Phone number verified successfully",
    "user": {
      "userId": "6ac4ba…",
      "name": "Rahul Sharma",
      "phoneNumber": "9000000031",
      "currentLocation": {
        "locationText": "WJVF+2RR, KHB Games Village, Koramangala, Bengaluru, Karnataka 5600…",
        "area": "KHB Games Village",
        "city": "Bengaluru",
        "state": "Karnataka",
        "postalCode": "560095",
        "country": "India",
  …
```

3. Location

Skip this screen when `user.currentLocation` from verify is not null.

When	Call	Returns
GPS allowed	`PUT /users/me/location { latitude, longitude }`	Place name + `serviceability`
User types an area	`GET /geo/autocomplete?input=&latitude=&longitude=&sessionToken=`	Up to 8: placeId, primaryText, secondaryText, description
User picks a suggestion	`GET /geo/place/:placeId?sessionToken=`	latitude, longitude, fullAddress, locality, city, pincode; then PUT location
Pincode only	`GET /serviceability/pincode/:pincode`	Same shape as serviceability
Check without saving	`GET /serviceability?latitude=&longitude=`	serviceability

Use one random `sessionToken` per search (typing until a pick). Place search needs the Places API on the server's Google key; until then it returns 502, so offer GPS, pincode and saved addresses.

`PUT /users/me/location` response


```
{
  "locationText": "WJVF+2RR, KHB Games Village, Koramangala, Bengaluru, Karnataka 5600…",
  "area": "KHB Games Village",
  "city": "Bengaluru",
  "state": "Karnataka",
  "postalCode": "560095",
  "country": "India",
  "latitude": 12.942795,
  "longitude": 77.624478,
  "updatedAt": "2026-10-09T08:41:47.155Z",
  "serviceability": {
    "serviceable": true,
    "distanceKm": 0.8,
    "etaMinutes": 28,
    "etaLabel": "23–33 min",
    "deliveryFeePaise": 4000,
    "deliveryFeeMode": "flat",
    "freeDeliveryAbovePaise": 29900,
    "minOrderPaise": 0,
    "codEnabled": true,
    "pickupEnabled": false,
    "isOpenNow": true,
    "reason": null,
    "opensAt": null,
  …
```


Not served


```
{
  "serviceable": false,
  "reason": "not_serviceable",
  "kitchen": null,
  "distanceKm": null,
  "message": "We don't deliver here yet. We'll let you know when we do."
}
```


4. Saved addresses

Action	Call
List (default first)	`GET /users/me/addresses`
Add	`POST /users/me/addresses`
Edit	`PATCH /users/me/addresses/:id`
Make default	`PATCH /users/me/addresses/:id/default`
Delete	`DELETE /users/me/addresses/:id`

Required to add: houseFlat, city, pincode, latitude, longitude. `label` is home, work or other (+ customLabel). Each address returns `serviceable`, `kitchenId` and `distanceKm`. When the user picks an address, call `PUT /users/me/location` with its coordinates and reload home.

5. Home: GET /home

`GET /home?latitude=12.942795&longitude=77.624478` returns the whole home screen. Send the selected location (latitude and longitude together, or neither). Add `&veg=true` for veg-only; without it the saved Veg toggle applies.

Top-level fields


```
{
  "greeting": "Good afternoon, Rahul",
  "deliverTo": {
    "source": "address",
    "addressId": "6ac76e…",
    "label": "Home",
    "line": "Koramangala, Bengaluru",
    "city": "Bengaluru"
  },
  "vegOnly": false,
  "serviceability": {
    "serviceable": true,
    "reason": null,
    "etaLabel": "23–33 min",
    "deliveryFeePaise": 4000,
    "freeDeliveryAbovePaise": 29900,
    "isOpenNow": true,
    "opensAt": null,
    "message": null
  },
  "cart": {
    "itemCount": 0,
    "kitchenId": null,
    "subtotalPaise": 0,
    "freeDeliveryAbovePaise": 29900,
    "amountToFreeDeliveryPaise": 29900,
    "amountToMinOrderPaise": 0,
    "fromOtherKitchen": false,
    "updatedAt": null
  },
  "unreadNotifications": 85,
  "subscription": {
    "subscriptionId": "6ac76e…",
    "status": "active",
  …
```


Field	Use it for
`header`	The seasonal header (section 6).
`deliverTo`	"Deliver to" pill: label (Home), line (Koramangala, Bengaluru), source address | location | point.
`serviceability.reason`	null = open; closed, paused, kitchen_unavailable, not_serviceable, no_location.
`cart`	Floating cart bar: itemCount, subtotalPaise, amountToFreeDeliveryPaise ("Add ₹X for free delivery"), fromOtherKitchen.
`unreadNotifications`	Bell dot when above 0.
`subscription`	Plus card: status, planName, daysLeft (null when not subscribed).

Sections

Render `sections` in order and switch on `type` (never on key). Skip types you don't know; hide a block when its section is missing.

type	items hold	Notes
`banners`	bannerId, eyebrow, title, highlight, subtitle, imageUrl, ctaLabel, deepLink, couponCode	Key hero = the carousel. highlight is the accent part of title.

type	items hold	Notes
`categories`	categoryId, name, subtitle, imageUrl, dishCount	Today's Menu tiles; tap → menu for that category.
`combos`	comboId, name, subtitle, imageUrl, pricePaise, originalPricePaise, servesCount, items[]	Also `banner` (the Meal Combos card).
`features`	icon, title, subtitle	icon picks a bundled icon: fast_delivery, fresh_ingredients, hygienic_kitchen.
`usual`	dishes	Missing for users with no orders.
`popular` / `recommended`	dishes	Same dish shape as the menu.
`subscription_promo`	planCode, name, subtitle, imageUrl, pricePaise, cycleLabel, benefits[]	Meal Ji Plus carousel.
`how_we_cook`	one banner	Tap → About the chef.

Dish shape: dishId, name, description, imageUrl, images[], pricePaise, originalPricePaise, isVeg, isAvailable, isBestseller, badge, spicyLevel, calories, preparationMinutes, customizationGroups[], ratingAvg, ratingCount.

Example sections (first item each)


```
[
  {
    "key": "hero",
    "type": "banners",
    "title": null,
    "subtitle": null,
    "items": [
      {
        "bannerId": "6ac76e…",
        "placement": "home_hero",
        "eyebrow": "OUR SIGNATURE CHICKEN BIRYANI",
        "title": "A BOWL OF HAPPINESS",
        "highlight": "HAPPINESS",
        "subtitle": "Rich flavours. Freshly cooked. Always for you.",
        "imageUrl": "https://…/seed/hero-chicken-biryani.jpg",
        "ctaLabel": "Order Now",
        "deepLink": "mealji://menu?category=biryani",
        "couponCode": null,
        "startsAt": null,
        "endsAt": null
      }
    ]
  },
  {
    "key": "categories",
    "type": "categories",
    "title": "Today's Menu",
    "subtitle": null,
    "items": [
      {
        "categoryId": "6ac76e…",
        "name": "Paneer",
        "icon": null,
        "subtitle": "Paneer, every way you like it",
        "imageUrl": "https://…/seed/paneer-bao.jpg",
        "sortOrder": 0,
        "isActive": true,
        "dishCount": 2
      }
    ]
  },
  {
    "key": "combos",
    "type": "combos",
  …
```

6. Header theme (seasonal top of home)

The coloured top block of HomeScreen.tsx (background, status bar and the Foodie Weekend card with the taco and sushi) comes from `header`, so the team can switch it to Halloween, Diwali or any campaign without an app release.



Live in the demo data now: Halloween: Spooky Bites
Orange-to-purple gradient, pumpkin left, ghost right, “Spooky Bites” with a BOO badge and a “GRAB A TREAT” button (coupon BOO131). The default theme (indigo, taco and sushi, Foodie Weekend) comes back after 1 Nov; Diwali runs 3–13 Nov.

Current response


```
{
  "themeId": "6ac899…",
  "name": "Halloween: Spooky Bites",
  "endsAt": "2026-10-31T18:30:00.000Z",
  "header": {
    "backgroundColors": [
      "#FF7A00",
      "#3B0A57",
      "#1A0B2E"
    ],
    "gradientAngle": 160,
    "backgroundImageUrl": null,
    "statusBarStyle": "light",
    "statusBarColor": "#3B0A57",
    "textColor": "#FFFFFF",
    "subTextColor": "#FFE0B2"
  },
  "promo": {
    "title": "Spooky Bites",
    "badge": "BOO",
    "subtitle": "Flat ₹131 OFF, trick or treat!",
    "ctaLabel": "GRAB A TREAT",
    "deepLink": "mealji://offers",
    "couponCode": "BOO131",
    "leftImageUrl": "https://…/seed/halloween-pumpkin.png",
    "rightImageUrl": "https://…/seed/halloween-ghost.png",
    "backgroundColors": [
      "#2A0F45",
      "#14081F"
    ],
    "titleColor": "#FFB74D",
    "subtitleColor": "#FFFFFFCC",
    "ctaColor": "#FF7A00",
    "ctaTextColor": "#FFFFFF"
  }
}
```


Field	Render as
`header.backgroundColors`, `gradientAngle`	react-native-linear-gradient behind the header; angle follows CSS (180 = top to bottom, 90 = left to right). Replaces AppImages.topIndigoSection.
`header.backgroundImageUrl`	Optional image over the gradient, resizeMode cover.
`header.statusBarStyle`, `statusBarColor`	`<StatusBar barStyle="light-content" | "dark-content" backgroundColor={statusBarColor} />`
`header.textColor`, `subTextColor`	"Deliver to", greeting and question; location line and greeting line.
`promo`	The card under the search bar. null → hide the card.
`promo.leftImageUrl`, `rightImageUrl`	The two side images (taco and sushi today).
`promo.title`, `badge`, `subtitle`, `ctaLabel`	Card text; badge = small white pill after the title.
`promo.backgroundColors`	Card gradient; empty = transparent over the header.
`promo.*Color`	titleColor, subtitleColor, ctaColor (button), ctaTextColor.
`promo.deepLink`, `couponCode`	Button tap: open the link; pass the coupon to the offers screen.

Colours are #RRGGBB or #RRGGBBAA (last two digits = opacity, e.g. #FFFFFFCC = 80% white); React Native accepts both. Keep the current built-in header as a fallback if `header` is ever null.

7. HomeScreen.tsx: where each block gets its data

Block today	Hard-coded now	Comes from
Header background + status bar	AppImages.topIndigoSection, #2C40A6	`header.header`
"Deliver to" pill	'Jaya Prakash Nagar, Kanakapura...'	`deliverTo.label`, `deliverTo.line`
Bell dot	Always shown	`unreadNotifications > 0`
Greeting	Good Morning, Alex!	`greeting`
Veg / All toggle	Local state	`vegOnly`; save with `PATCH /users/me/preferences {vegOnly}`
Foodie Weekend card	Taco/sushi, fixed text	`header.promo`
Signature carousel (4 dots)	cauliflowerBowl + text	section key `hero`
Today's Menu tiles	MENU_ITEMS (Paneer, Daal, Roti)	type `categories`
Meal Combos card	AppImages.mealCombos	type `combos` → banner
Fast delivery / Fresh / Hygienic	Fixed text	type `features`
Your usual? (YourUsual.tsx)	3 fixed dishes	type `usual`
Meal Ji Plus (MealJiPlusBanner.tsx)	3 fixed plans	type `subscription_promo`; `subscription` if active
How we cook (HowWeCookBanner.tsx)	AppImages.howWeCook	type `how_we_cook`
Floating cart bar	cartItemCount from local state	`cart`

Keep bundled: icons, texticons, doodles, splash art and layout frames. Everything that is food, offers, plans or the chef comes from the API.

Deep links

deepLink fields use `mealji://`: `mealji://menu`, `mealji://menu?category=<slug>`, `mealji://menu?tab=combos`, `mealji://offers`, `mealji://plus`, `mealji://about-chef`. Ignore unknown links.

8. Calls from the home screen

Purpose	Call	When
Banner seen / tapped	`POST /banners/:id/impression` / `/click`	First time on screen; on tap. Fire and forget.
In-app message	`GET /in-app-messages?screen=home`	After home renders; [] when nothing.
In-app events	`POST /in-app-messages/:id/shown|clicked|dismissed`	When shown, tapped, closed.
Bell	`GET /notifications/unread-count`, `GET /notifications`	Foreground; bell tap.
Cart bar	`GET /cart`	After add/remove.
Category tap	`GET /dishes?categoryId=&kitchenId=&limit=20&page=1`	Also veg=true, q, sort.
About the chef	`GET /kitchen-about`	How we cook tap.
Plus card	`GET /subscription-plans`	Plans screen.
Search bar	`GET /search?q=`	Search screen.

Pass `kitchenId` (from `home.kitchen.kitchenId`) to menu calls so every screen uses the same kitchen as home.

9. States and errors

Situation	How you know	Show
Delivering	serviceable true, isOpenNow true	Full home; etaLabel in the header
Kitchen closed	reason closed, opensAt set	Home + "Opens at 8:00 AM" strip; ordering off
Kitchen paused	reason paused	Same strip with serviceability.message
Not served	serviceable false, reason not_serviceable	Banners + message + Change location (emptyClosedScene art)
No location	reason no_location	Send to the location screen
Section missing	not in sections	Hide that block
Offline	request fails	offlineScene + Retry

Status	Meaning	App action
400 / 422	Bad input; errors[] names fields	Show field messages
401	Access token expired	Refresh once, retry
403	Suspended or no access	Show message, sign out
404	Not found	Go back and reload
409	Business rule	Show message
429	Too many requests	Wait, then retry (no loops)
5xx	Server problem	Retry with backoff; friendly error

Reload home on app start, after login, after the location or address changes, on return to foreground after 5+ minutes, and on pull to refresh. Cache the last response and show it instantly on launch; the server caches banners and layout for up to 2 minutes, so polling faster shows nothing new.

10. Testing

What	Value
Base URL	`http://localhost:4000/api/v1` (emulator 10.0.2.2, device: the computer's LAN IP)
Login	Demo numbers below; the OTP is shared by the backend team
Rahul Sharma 9000000031	Returning customer, Plus member, Koramangala
Siddharth Rao 9000000037	Plus member, Indiranagar
Divya Pillai 9000000040	New customer (no "Your usual?")
Served points	12.942795, 77.624478 (pincode 560095) · 12.9759, 77.6362 (560038)
Not served	13.1986, 77.7066 (airport)
Postman	mealJiNode.postman_collection.json: App · … folders; GET /home has a saved Halloween example

Demo accounts never receive real SMS, WhatsApp, email or push; their notifications go to the in-app inbox only.

11. Next to integrate

- Menu and dish: `/menu/categories`, `/dishes`, `/menu/items/:id`, `/combos`, `/search`, favourites.
- Cart and checkout: `/cart`, `/cart/items`, `/cart/promo`, `/checkout/summary`.
- Order and pay: `POST /orders`, `/payments/verify`, `/orders/:id/live`, `/orders/:id/tracking`.
- A separate guide for these follows; the endpoints are already in Postman.